



We'll shortly consider some ways of responding to Edwards' argument. But first let's think about how Edwards' argument might be related to an argument for fatalism.

There are truths  
about our future  
actions.

In the past, God  
had  
foreknowledge of  
our future  
actions.

We started off with two arguments for the reality of fate.

We have no  
choice about the  
past.

Let's turn to our last line of response to the two arguments. This is to deny the assumption, common to both arguments, that we have no choice about the past.

The denial of this assumption is often associated with William of Ockham, an English philosopher and theologian who was born about 15 years after Aquinas' death, in 1288. (He's the one that "Ockham's razor" is named after.)





To see why this might not be ridiculous, consider the overlooked philosophical problem of the incompatibility of free will and roommate belief.

It seems that sometimes, your roommate can have beliefs about what you will do; for example, the following might be true:

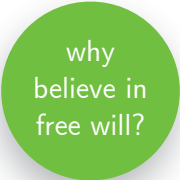
At 10 am today, your roommate  
believed that you would eat a salad  
for lunch.



two  
arguments  
against free  
will



is fate  
real?



why  
believe in  
free will?



three  
ways out



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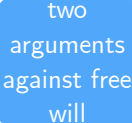


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never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a



So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

actions. Could they give an argument

similar to Edwards' argument?

Edwards' argument — but did believe that



Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

with reference to the being of truth about

our future actions.

replace reference to God's foreknowledge





2\*In the past, there were truths about

acaioid.

4. If we have no choice about  $p$ , and no

all of our activities.

choice about the fact that if  $p$ , then  $q$ ,

that if it is true that I will perform

God knows that in the future I will

1. We have no direct facts.



3 We have not the fact that

then we have the choice about q.

5\* We have noticed that the fact

will perform various actions.

some action, then I will prefer that

perform a certain action (1,2)

0 We have achieved what we

(3, 4, 5)





The fatalist argument

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to



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valid and more immediate true belief.

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